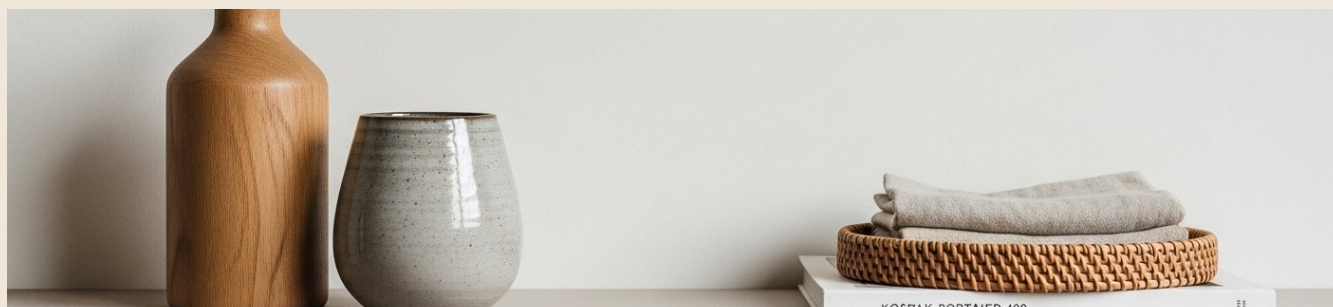


THE STYLING LESSON

Stillness is designed, not found

Of the seven principles behind Japanese Zen aesthetics, the one winter rooms need is *seijaku* — 静寂 — usually translated as "tranquillity," but closer to an active, energised calm. Not the silence of an empty room. The composure of a room where every element has been decided.

You build it with three moves. **Subtract to one focal object per sightline** — the eye should land somewhere on purpose, not wander a busy surface. **Keep the negative space** — *ma*, the interval — as a designed element, not a gap waiting to be filled; the empty half of the shelf is the reason the full half reads as calm. **And hold the single accent** — one ember, once — so the room has a pulse without a clamour.



Calm & Oak